# LITTLE WITNESSES:
# EPISODE 1: THE SMALLEST LUNCH

Written by

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EXT. MIRI'S VILLAGE — MORNING

Warm sunlight spills over a small ancient village. Clay homes. Woven baskets. Goats nosing through straw. A baker pulls flatbread from a clay oven. Children dart between adults carrying water jars and bundles of reeds.

MIRI runs through the lane with NIM at her heels. Nim bounds lightly, oversized ears bouncing, nose twitching.

Miri clutches a small cloth bundle close to her chest.

NIM
Is it bread?

MIRI
No.

NIM
Is it meat?

MIRI
No.

NIM
Is it bread pretending not to be bread?

MIRI stops beside a low wall and peeks inside the bundle. Three small HONEY-DATE CAKES gleam in the cloth.

Nim gasps as though beholding treasure.

NIM
It is better than bread.

MIRI
Ima made them for after chores.

NIM
How many chores?

MIRI
One.

NIM
And how many cakes?

MIRI
Three.

NIM
A perfect arrangement. Let no one disturb it.

Miri smiles and folds the cloth shut just as IMA appears from the doorway with a basket of folded linen.

IMA
Miri, take these to Saba Elior, please. His old sleeves are more patch than sleeve.

MIRI
Again?

IMA
Again. And if you pass Tav on the way, give him one of the honey cakes.

Miri freezes.

Nim freezes too. He slowly turns toward Miri, eyes wide.

NIM
Perhaps there are two Tavs. We should confirm before making decisions.

MIRI
Ima, Tav had a cake yesterday.

IMA
And you have three today.

MIRI looks down at the cloth bundle.

MIRI
But if I give one away, I will only have two.

IMA
That is usually how giving works.

MIRI
But I was going to save one for later.

IMA kneels, warm but firm.

IMA
Small hands can still be open hands.

MIRI
But what if there is not enough?

Ima studies her. She does not force it.

IMA
Then ask Saba what he thinks. He always has a story tucked somewhere.

Miri exhales, not satisfied.

MIRI
Stories do not fill empty stomachs.

Nim pats his own belly with grave agreement.

NIM
At last, wisdom.

Ima hands Miri the linen basket. Miri tucks the honey cakes deeper inside the cloth.

EXT. VILLAGE LANE — MOMENTS LATER

Miri walks with the linen basket. Nim trots beside her, eyes glued to the hidden cakes.

TAV, a small boy with dust on his cheeks, sits beside a broken toy cart. One wooden wheel has popped off.

TAV
Miri! Did your mother make cakes?

Miri instinctively shields the basket.

MIRI
Maybe.

TAV
I can smell them.

NIM
A gifted child. Dangerous.

Tav looks hopeful.

TAV
Could I have one?

Miri hesitates. Her hand goes to the cloth. She imagines the three cakes becoming two. Two becoming one. One becoming none.

MIRI
I… have to take these to Saba.

TAV
The cakes?

MIRI
The linen.

TAV
Oh.

Miri looks down, feeling a pinch of guilt, but she pushes past it.

MIRI
Maybe later.

Tav nods, disappointed, and returns to his broken cart.

Miri hurries away. Nim follows.

NIM
A difficult moment. Very brave of us to continue carrying the cakes.

MIRI
I heard that.

NIM
I intended you to. I am supporting the mission.

Miri glances back at Tav. His little cart wobbles, wheel still off.

She keeps walking.

MAIN TITLES

A warm, painted title card unfurls like parchment.

LITTLE WITNESSES “THE SMALLEST LUNCH”

ACT ONE

EXT. SABA ELIOR’S COURTYARD — LATE MORNING

SABA ELIOR sits beneath a fig tree, surrounded by several village children. He is repairing a sandal with one hand and gesturing grandly with the other.

SABA
And so the little sparrow said to the great camel, “If your knees bend, perhaps your pride may also.”

A few children giggle. Others are distracted. One pokes a beetle with a reed. Another tries to balance a fig on his nose.

Miri enters with the linen basket. She slows, listening.

SABA
But the camel did not listen, because camels are very good at chewing and very poor at hearing wisdom.

Miri smiles despite herself.

A GIRL spots a group of older children playing with a hoop in the lane.

GIRL
Come on!

The children scatter after her, laughing.

Saba watches them go, amused, not offended.

Miri remains.

SABA
Ah. One listener left. Either my story improved, or your feet forgot to follow the others.

MIRI
What happened to the sparrow?

Saba’s eyes brighten. He pats the ground beside him.

SABA
The right question.

Miri sits. Nim noses around the fig tree roots.

SABA
The sparrow flew where the camel could not see and found water hidden under stones.

MIRI
Because it was small?

SABA
Because it was willing to look where large eyes had stopped looking.

Miri considers this. Then remembers why she came and pushes the linen basket toward him.

MIRI
Ima sent sleeves.

SABA takes the linen and inspects his sleeve, which is patched in three places.

SABA
At last. My elbows shall rejoin polite society.

Nim hops up and sniffs the basket.

Saba sees the movement but not the intention.

SABA
And perhaps one little hunter should not climb inside my clean linen.

Nim freezes, one paw in the basket.

NIM
He suspects nothing.

Miri pulls Nim back.

SABA notices the cloth bundle tucked beneath the linen.

SABA
You have brought something sweet.

MIRI
For after chores.

SABA
A wise time for sweetness.

MIRI
Ima said I should give one to Tav.

SABA waits.

MIRI
But Tav did not help make them. And there were only three. If I gave him one, I would have fewer.

Nim sits up, solemn as a judge.

NIM
The arithmetic is sound.

SABA
Fewer cakes.

MIRI
Yes.

SABA
And perhaps… less Miri?

Miri frowns.

MIRI
What does that mean?

SABA
You tell me. When your hand opens, do you become smaller?

MIRI
No. But what I have becomes smaller.

SABA
Ah.

He stands, joints creaking cheerfully.

SABA
Then we need a story with a very small lunch.

Nim's ears perk.

NIM
A story about lunch? I withdraw all objections.

Saba gestures toward the doorway of his house.

SABA
Come. Let us see whether the scrolls have eaten before us.

INT. SABA'S HOUSE — CONTINUOUS

Miri steps inside. The room is warm and crowded with ordinary things: clay cups, woven mats, lamps, baskets, jars of ink, old maps, small tools, herbs drying by a window.

Saba pulls aside a faded hanging cloth.

Behind it: THE SCROLL ROOM.

INT. SCROLL ROOM — CONTINUOUS

Miri stops at the threshold.

The room is not huge, but it feels endless. Shelves climb the walls. Scrolls of different sizes rest in niches. Some are sealed with cord. Some lie open, edges lifting gently though there is no wind.

Dust motes hang in shafts of light.

Nim peeks around Miri's legs.

NIM
I see no lunch.

MIRI
You see old scrolls.

NIM
Exactly my concern.

Saba moves slowly along the shelves, fingers hovering over scrolls as though greeting old friends.

SABA
There are scrolls about kings, scrolls about rivers, scrolls about storms, scrolls about shepherds who smelled like sheep and prophets who probably wished they smelled better.

Miri follows, entranced.

MIRI
Do the other children ever come in here?

SABA
Sometimes.

MIRI
Do they see all this?

SABA
They see shelves. Dust. Old words.

MIRI
And I see… more.

Saba glances at her with fondness.

SABA
That is why I keep a place for you on the floor.

He reaches high and draws down a small scroll tied with a cord the color of barley.

A wax seal bears the shape of a loaf and two fish.

Nim's whole body goes alert.

NIM
Now we are discussing serious matters.

SABA
This is a story of a hillside, a hungry crowd, and one boy who carried almost nothing.

MIRI
Almost nothing does not feed a crowd.

SABA
No. Not by itself.

He sits cross-legged. Miri sits opposite him. Nim curls near Miri, still eyeing the honey cake bundle.

Saba unties the cord.

The scroll exhales softly.

Ink glimmers.

Tiny drawn grains of barley lift off the parchment like fireflies. Lines of ink stretch into hills. The smell of grass and lake wind fills the room.

Saba's voice lowers into story.

SABA
There was a day when many people followed Jesus across the hills of Galilee. They came with questions, with sickness, with hope, with children on their shoulders and dust on their feet.

The scroll room brightens. Painted hills ripple across the walls. Threads of parchment unfurl overhead like clouds.

SABA (V.O.)
They came to listen. They came to be near Him. And as the sun climbed high, stomachs began to speak almost as loudly as hearts.

Nim clutches his belly.

NIM
I understand these people deeply.

The floor beneath Miri becomes soft grass. The shelves stretch upward into bright sky.

Miri looks to Saba, but he is now beyond the veil of the story, still seated in the Scroll Room, his voice carrying through.

MIRI
Saba?

SABA (V.O.)
Listen closely, Miri. Some gifts look too small until they are placed in the right hands.

The light blooms.

ACT TWO

EXT. GALILEAN HILLSIDE — DAY

Miri and Nim stand on a sunlit hillside above a shining blue lake. Grass bends in a warm breeze. Families gather in clusters. Children chase each other around seated adults. Disciples move among the crowd, concerned.

In the distance, JESUS stands on a rise. We see Him from behind and slightly to the side: robe moving in the wind, hands open as people listen. His face is not shown.

The atmosphere is peaceful, expectant, alive.

Miri spins, amazed.

MIRI
We are inside the story.

NIM
We are inside a story full of hungry people. That is a very specific kind of danger.

MIRI
No one can hear you except me.

NIM
A tragedy for the people. I have advice.

A group of children rush past. One nearly bumps Miri.

CHILD
Sorry!

The child does not notice anything unusual about them.

Miri looks at her own clothes. They fit the world naturally, as if she belongs.

MIRI
Saba said we listen until the story changes us.

NIM
Wonderful. I shall listen near anyone with snacks.

They move through the crowd.

EXT. HILLSIDE PATH — CONTINUOUS

Miri spots a boy, YONAH, about her age, weaving through the crowd with a small bundle tucked under his arm. He is careful, bright-eyed, slightly nervous.

He stops when he sees a very small GIRL crying beside her mother.

SMALL GIRL
I'm hungry.

The mother comforts her but has no food.

Yonah looks down at his bundle. He hesitates, then keeps walking, troubled.

Miri notices.

MIRI
You have food.

Yonah turns.

YONAH
A little.

Nim instantly appears beside the bundle.

NIM
How little?

Miri nudges Nim away with her foot.

MIRI
I'm Miri.

YONAH
Yonah.

MIRI
Are you saving it?

YONAH
My mother packed it for me. Five barley loaves. Two fish.

Nim sways, overcome.

NIM
Five. And two. Numbers of beauty.

MIRI
That is not enough for all these people.

Yonah glances at the crowd.

YONAH
No.

MIRI
So you should probably keep it.

Yonah looks at her, unsure.

YONAH
Do you think so?

Miri looks around at the thousands spread across the hillside.

MIRI
If you give some away, you will only have less.

Yonah's fingers tighten around the bundle.

YONAH
Less than a little is not much.

NIM
A boy of excellent judgment.

A DISCIPLE passes nearby, speaking urgently to another.

PHILIP
The day is fading, and they have been here long. There is no village near enough for such a crowd.

ANDREW
The Teacher knows.

PHILIP
But where shall we buy bread for all these people?

Miri watches the disciples walk toward the rise where Jesus stands.

YONAH
They are worried.

MIRI
Adults worry when there are not enough baskets.

YONAH
My mother says the Lord can fill what we cannot.

MIRI
With five loaves?

Yonah does not answer. He looks again at the little girl crying softly.

EXT. EDGE OF CROWD — LATER

The sun has shifted. The crowd has grown. People settle on the grass in groups. Some shade their eyes. Children lean against parents.

Miri, Nim, and Yonah sit on a small rise.

Yonah unwraps the lunch. Five small barley loaves. Two small fish. Simple. Ordinary. Definitely not enough.

Nim stares with reverence.

NIM
I have seen palaces less beautiful.

Miri’s stomach growls.

Nim’s stomach growls louder.

NIM
Mine is echoing in sympathy.

Yonah breaks off a tiny crumb and offers it to Miri.

YONAH
Do you want a little?

Miri hesitates. The crumb is tiny. She remembers Tav's hopeful face.

MIRI
No. You keep it.

Nim looks betrayed.

NIM
We are declining crumbs now?

Miri ignores him.

Below, the disciples gather around Jesus. We see only the lower edge of Jesus's robe, His hand resting gently on a staff, the faces of the disciples looking toward Him.

ANDREW notices Yonah's bundle from a distance. He approaches.

ANDREW
Peace to you, young one.

Yonah quickly wraps the lunch.

YONAH
Peace.

ANDREW
You have brought food?

Yonah looks to Miri.

Miri gives a tiny shake of her head: don't.

Yonah looks down at the bundle.

YONAH
Only a little.

ANDREW
What do you have?

YONAH
Five barley loaves and two fish.

Andrew smiles kindly, but his brow remains troubled.

ANDREW
Five loaves. Two fish.

He looks across the sea of people.

ANDREW (SOFTLY)
But what are they among so many?

Miri quietly nods, as though the matter is settled.

Yonah's face falls.

Andrew is about to return to the disciples when Yonah stands.

YONAH
Wait.

Miri grabs his sleeve.

MIRI
Yonah.

Yonah looks at her.

MIRI
If you give it away, you may not get any back.

Yonah looks afraid now. He is a child. His lunch is real. His hunger is real.

YONAH
I know.

MIRI
Then why give it?

Yonah looks toward Jesus. We see the silhouette of Jesus kneeling to place a hand on a sick man's shoulder. The man's family weeps with relief.

YONAH
Because if I keep it, it stays small.

Miri has no answer.

Nim's ears lower. Even he is quiet.

Yonah steps toward Andrew, holding out the bundle with both hands.

YONAH
You may take it to Him.

Andrew receives the lunch with great care. He does not make Yonah feel foolish.

ANDREW
Come with me.

Yonah follows. Miri and Nim trail behind.

EXT. NEAR JESUS — CONTINUOUS

The crowd noise softens.

Miri slows as they near Jesus. The framing becomes reverent and restrained.

We see Jesus's hands receive the small lunch from Andrew. His robe. The disciples' faces. Yonah looking up, nervous and hopeful. Miri watching, guarded.

JESUS (GENTLE, WARM)
Have the people sit down.

A ripple moves through the disciples.

PHILIP
All of them?

Jesus's hand rests briefly on the basket holding the bread.

JESUS
All of them.

The disciples hurry to organize the crowd.

ANDREW
In groups! Sit upon the grass. Make room for one another.

The command spreads outward.

Miri watches people sitting in widening circles.

MIRI
He did not say there was enough.

YONAH
No.

MIRI
He told them to sit as if there was.

Yonah nods slowly.

NIM whispers, deeply unsettled.

NIM
Sitting before seeing food is a bold policy.

EXT. HILLSIDE — MOMENTS LATER

The hillside transforms into a living pattern: thousands seated in clusters on green grass. Children settle against parents. Dust glows in sunbeams. The lake sparkles below.

Miri helps a grandmother find a place to sit. Nim darts out of the way of many sandals.

NIM
So many feet. None of them looking for foxes.

Miri looks toward the small girl from earlier, still hungry, now seated near her mother.

Miri touches the empty space at her own side where, in the home world, the honey cakes would be.

Then — a hush.

Jesus lifts the loaves. We see His hands. He gives thanks.

No spectacle yet. Just stillness.

Wind moves through the grass.

The first loaf breaks.

Then another.

Hands pass bread into a basket.

A disciple looks down, startled. There is more bread than should be there.

He hands a piece to another. The basket remains full.

Fish are shared. Another basket fills. Then another.

The miracle begins quietly, then blooms.

VISUAL SET PIECE — THE MULTIPLICATION

Baskets pass from hand to hand. Bread breaks and remains. Fish are portioned and more appears beneath the cloth. Children’s eyes widen. Parents laugh in disbelief.

Disciples who were worried moments ago now move faster and faster, overflowing with joy.

Miri stands at the center of the movement as baskets sweep past like currents in a river.

A basket is placed in her hands.

ANDREW
Can you carry this to the children there?

Miri looks into the basket: warm barley loaves, enough for many.

She looks to Yonah.

He is laughing now, overwhelmed.

YONAH
Go!

Miri takes the basket. Nim trots beside her, trying very hard not to stare into it.

NIM
I am thinking generous thoughts.

MIRI
You are staring at the bread.

NIM
Generously.

Miri kneels beside the small girl and her mother. She offers the basket.

MIRI
There is enough.

The small girl takes a piece in both hands.

SMALL GIRL
For me?

Miri smiles, softer now.

MIRI
For you.

The girl’s mother receives food with tears in her eyes.

MOTHER IN CROWD
Blessed be the Lord.

Miri moves on, passing bread to children, elders, fathers, mothers. Every time she thinks the basket should be empty, more remains.

The hillside fills with eating, laughter, relief. Hunger turns to wonder.

Nim watches a crumb fall near his paw. He looks at Miri. He looks at the crumb.

MIRI
Wait.

Nim trembles with discipline.

NIM
I am a statue of patience.

A child giggles and offers Nim a tiny piece.

CHILD
Here, little fox.

Nim gently takes it. His eyes close in bliss.

NIM
I forgive all suspense.

Miri laughs, but her gaze drifts back to Jesus’s hands as He continues to give.

The miracle does not feel like a trick. It feels like kindness becoming visible.

ACT THREE

EXT. HILLSIDE — LATE AFTERNOON

The crowd has eaten. Families sit together, satisfied. The light is golden. Children lie on the grass, sleepy and content.

Disciples move through the crowd with empty baskets.

ANDREW
Gather the pieces left over, that nothing may be lost.

Miri hears this and looks up.

MIRI
Nothing lost.

Yonah approaches, carrying a half-filled basket of leftover pieces. His face still shines with wonder.

YONAH
Miri, help me?

Miri nods.

EXT. HILLSIDE — CONTINUOUS

Miri, Yonah, and Nim gather leftover pieces of bread. Nim picks one up in his mouth, then freezes when Miri looks at him.

NIM
I was gathering internally.

MIRI
Basket.

Nim drops the piece into the basket with exaggerated dignity.

NIM
Of course.

They move through the grass. Miri notices there are twelve baskets now, each filling with leftovers.

MIRI
Yonah.

YONAH
Yes?

MIRI
You gave five loaves and two fish.

YONAH
Yes.

MIRI
And now there are more baskets left than the lunch you started with.

Yonah looks at the baskets, amazed all over again.

YONAH
I thought I was giving Him my lunch.

MIRI
You were.

YONAH
But He gave it to everyone.

Miri holds a leftover piece gently in her hand.

MIRI
Were you afraid?

Yonah smiles, embarrassed.

YONAH
Very.

MIRI
I told you not to give it.

YONAH
I heard.

MIRI
I thought giving would only make less.

Yonah thinks.

YONAH
Maybe in our hands. Not in His.

Miri absorbs this.

Nearby, the small girl from earlier runs to her mother with a piece of bread saved in her hand.

SMALL GIRL
For later.

Her mother laughs and kisses her forehead.

Miri smiles, then looks down at the piece she is holding. She places it in the basket instead of keeping it.

Nim watches this with exaggerated heartbreak.

NIM
There goes a noble crumb.

MIRI
Nothing lost.

Nim brightens.

NIM
Oh. Right. It is being organized.

Andrew receives their basket.

ANDREW
Thank you, children.

He looks at Yonah.

ANDREW (GENTLE)
Your small lunch has filled many hands.

Yonah blushes and looks toward Jesus.

YONAH
I only gave it.

ANDREW
Yes.

Andrew’s smile deepens.

ANDREW
Sometimes that is the part given to us.

Miri watches the baskets being gathered. Twelve full baskets. More than enough.

The hillside glows.

EXT. HILLSIDE RIDGE — SUNSET

Miri stands apart for a moment, looking over the crowd. Nim sits beside her, quiet after eating one approved crumb.

MIRI
Nim?

NIM
Yes?

MIRI
I think I should have given Tav the cake.

Nim swallows.

NIM
I was hoping you would not connect those scrolls.

MIRI
I was afraid there would not be enough for me.

NIM
There were only three.

MIRI
But Tav was hungry too.

NIM
Or cake-hopeful. A serious condition.

Miri gives him a look.

NIM
Yes. Hungry too.

MIRI
Yonah’s lunch looked too small. But he opened his hands.

She looks back toward Jesus. We see only His silhouette now, surrounded by people at peace.

MIRI
And God made it more than enough.

Nim’s ears lower softly.

NIM
Do you think… generosity hurts less after the first bite?

Miri smiles.

MIRI
Maybe after the first gift.

A warm gust of wind lifts around them. The hillside becomes parchment at the edges. Grass strokes turn into ink lines. The crowd softens into painted figures. The sunset becomes golden scroll light.

Saba’s voice returns.

SABA (V.O.)
And when all had eaten, they gathered what remained, so that nothing given in love would be forgotten.

Miri looks for Yonah. He waves from the edge of the fading hillside.

YONAH
Peace, Miri!

MIRI
Peace, Yonah!

Nim waves with his tail.

NIM
Remember me kindly, lunch boy.

The world rolls gently back into parchment.

ACT FOUR

INT. SCROLL ROOM — LATE AFTERNOON

Miri and Nim are back on the floor of the Scroll Room.

The small scroll rests open between them. Its ink settles into the drawing of five loaves and two fish.

Saba sits exactly where he was, as if only a breath has passed. His eyes twinkle, but he says nothing for a moment.

Miri looks down at the cloth bundle in her basket.

She opens it.

Three honey-date cakes.

Nim leans close.

NIM
All present. A miracle of inventory.

Miri lifts one cake.

MIRI
Saba?

SABA
Yes, little one?

MIRI
Did the boy know what would happen?

SABA
I do not think so.

MIRI
Then how did he give it?

Saba takes the question seriously.

SABA
Perhaps he knew only the next small thing: his hands were full, and others were hungry.

Miri considers this.

MIRI
I wanted to keep all three.

SABA
I noticed your basket was guarded like a city gate.

Nim looks offended.

NIM
Security was appropriate.

Saba notices Nim sitting upright, chest puffed.

SABA
And guarded by a fierce creature of suspiciously sticky whiskers.

Nim quickly licks honey from his whisker.

NIM
No evidence remains.

Miri smiles, then grows thoughtful.

MIRI
Giving does not make me smaller.

Saba’s expression softens.

SABA
No.

MIRI
And small things can still bless someone.

SABA
When offered with love, even a little can become more than we imagined.

Miri closes the cloth around the cakes and stands.

MIRI
I need to find Tav.

SABA
Then go before Nim begins a second inspection.

Nim is already half inside the basket.

NIM
I am checking for structural weakness.

Miri scoops him up.

MIRI
Come on.

EXT. VILLAGE LANE — SUNSET

The village is warmer now, settling into evening. Smoke rises from cooking fires. Animals are guided into pens. Children are called home.

Tav still sits by the low wall. His toy cart is now partly repaired but the wheel wobbles badly.

Miri approaches.

MIRI
Tav?

He looks up.

TAV
Did Saba fix his sleeves?

MIRI
Not yet. He got distracted by a very small lunch.

Tav blinks, confused.

Miri sits beside him and opens the cloth.

She takes out one honey-date cake.

Then, after a beat, she takes out a second and breaks it in half.

Nim’s eyes widen.

NIM
A generous escalation.

Miri gives Tav one whole cake and half of another.

TAV
For me?

Miri nods.

MIRI
For you.

Tav beams.

TAV
Thank you!

He takes a bite, delighted.

Miri looks at the remaining cake and half. She breaks the half into two small pieces, gives one to Nim, and keeps one.

NIM stares at the tiny piece.

NIM
Small, but emotionally significant.
Miri laughs and eats her piece.

Tav holds up his broken toy cart.

TAV
Can you help with the wheel?

Miri looks at the toy. Then at the fading sunlight.

MIRI
I can try.

Nim chews slowly, then noses a small peg toward Miri.

NIM
I am also giving. Please note the sacrifice.

Miri uses the peg to fix the wheel more securely.

The cart rolls a short distance, straight this time.

TAV
It works!

He laughs and pushes it again. Miri laughs too.

From down the lane, Saba watches from his doorway, sleeves still unpatched, smiling.

Ima steps beside him.

IMA
Did she ask you what you thought?

SABA
She asked a better question.

IMA
What was that?

SABA
What happens when a small hand opens?

They watch Miri, Tav, and Nim share the last crumbs as sunset settles over the village.

EXT. SABA'S COURTYARD — EVENING

Miri returns with Nim beside her. Saba sits again beneath the fig tree, sewing a patch onto his sleeve.

Miri sits beside him, quieter now.

MIRI
Saba?

SABA
Mm?

MIRI
Will the story still be there tomorrow?

SABA
The scroll, yes.

MIRI
No. The hillside. Yonah. The baskets.

Saba ties off a stitch.

SABA
A true story has a way of staying where it is needed.

MIRI
In the scroll room?

SABA
In the heart.

Miri lets this settle.

MIRI
I did not change the story.

SABA
No.

MIRI
But it changed me a little.

Saba smiles.

SABA
That is how the best stories begin their work.

Nim climbs into the linen basket and circles twice before curling up.

NIM
For future generosity, I recommend we begin with six cakes.

Miri gives him a look.

NIM
Five?

Saba, watching only Nim’s hopeful posture, reaches into a small pouch and pulls out a plain crumb of flatbread. He tosses it gently to Nim.

SABA
For the fierce guardian of linen.

Nim catches it, stunned.

NIM
At last, my service is recognized.

Miri laughs. Saba laughs too, though he does not know why.

The camera rises above the courtyard: Miri, Saba, Nim, warm lamplight, the open door to the Scroll Room beyond.

Inside the room, the little scroll glows softly on its shelf.

FADE OUT.